THEME

BRAND GUIDELINES

THE *ACADEMO SPORTS* IDENTITY

How the logo, colors, type and voice work together, so every email to a coach, athlete profile and highlight reel looks and sounds like one agency.

VERSION 1.0 COLLEGE SOCCER RECRUITING ACADEMOSPORTS.COM

CORE ASSET

LOGO

The horizontal lockup is the primary signature: the triangular A/S monogram next to the wordmark. Use it wherever there is room. The monogram alone covers tight spaces and app icons.



PRIMARY · ON CREAM

Default lockup

academo sports

REVERSED · ON AUBERGINE

Dark backgrounds

Monogram use: app icon, social avatar, favicon, watermark on video. Keep generous padding around it; never crop the triangle.

CLEAR SPACE & MINIMUM SIZE



Keep clear space on all sides equal to the height of the monogram's inner counter. Nothing (text, other logos, image edges) enters this zone.



PRINT · 28 MM WIDE MIN



SCREEN · 120 PX WIDE MIN

Below these sizes the wordmark loses legibility. In smaller spaces use the monogram instead of the full lockup.

MISUSE



✕ Don't stretch or distort



✕ Don't recolor outside the palette



✕ Don't rotate or tilt



✕ Don't add shadows or effects



× Don't place on low-contrast grounds



× Don't crowd the clear space

CORE + RECOMMENDED

COLOR

Two colors are fixed by the logo: aubergine and cream. The rest is a supporting system I recommend so the brand has enough range for web, documents and video without drifting off-palette.

CORE PALETTE FROM YOUR LOGO

AUBERGINE
HEX #41193B
RGB 65 · 25 · 59

CREAM
HEX #FDF3E8
RGB 253 · 243 · 232

SUPPORTING PALETTE RECOMMENDED

PLUM INK
HEX #2A1024
Text · deep backgrounds

AUBERGINE 600
HEX #5A2451
Hover · structural fills

MAUVE
HEX #8A5E80
Dividers · large text only

MAUVE TINT
HEX #E7D7E2
Subtle panels · highlights

WARM NEUTRAL

HEX #4A3F45

Body text on light

GOLD (optional)

HEX #C0892E

Awards · sparingly only

The optional gold is for rare emphasis (a standout stat, an award). It is not a second brand color. If in doubt, leave it out and stay on aubergine and cream.

USAGE BALANCE

Cream 60% | **Aubergine 30%** | **Accent 10%**

Lead with cream space, build structure in aubergine, use mauve or gold only as a small accent.

CONTRAST & LEGIBILITY

AUBERGINE ON CREAM

≈ 11.6:1 · passes AA + AAA for all text

CREAM ON AUBERGINE

≈ 11.6:1 · passes AA + AAA for all text

MAUVE ON CREAM

≈ 3.3:1 · large text / UI only, never body copy

RECOMMENDED

TYPOGRAPHY

The logo wordmark is a display face kept exclusively for the logo. For everything else, a two-width system built on the Barlow superfamily: condensed for impact, regular for reading. Both are free, on Google Fonts, and read as athletic without looking like a template.

BARLOW SEMI CONDENSED

Display & headlines. Weights 700–800, usually uppercase. Names, headlines, stat callouts, labels. Tight, confident, jersey-like.

Barlow Regular

Body & interface. Weights 400–600. Paragraphs, profile text, email body, captions. Clean and highly legible at small sizes.

DISPLAY	**LEIS HUSIC**
H2	**CENTER BACK · 2027**
H3 / LABEL	**HIGHLIGHT REEL**
BODY	A 6'3" center back from Germany, available for Fall 2027.
CAPTION	info@academosports.com · academosports.com

> **On the logo font:** the wordmark is a custom, heavy, oblique display type. Its exact name cannot be confirmed from the artwork, so treat it as a locked logo asset: do not try to recreate headlines in it. Keep it inside the logo file only, and set all other type in Barlow.

RECOMMENDED

VOICE & TONE

Academo sells trust to college coaches. The voice is built to earn it: concrete, confident, and honest. Proof beats hype every time.

01

Proof-led

Lead with verifiable facts: height, position, class year, real numbers. Let the credential carry the weight, not adjectives.

02

Confident, not boastful

State what is true plainly. No empty superlatives a coach has heard a hundred times this week.

03

Personal

Coach to coach, human to human. Warm and direct, never a mass-blast tone even when it is one.

04

Honest

Never claim what cannot be backed. One exposed exaggeration costs the agency every future email.

DO

- ✓ *"6'3" center back, already playing senior men's football at 18."*
- ✓ Open with position and class year, the first things a coach filters on.
- ✓ Keep it short. The job of the email is the click, not the full story.
- ✓ State eligibility as intent ("available for Fall 2027") until it is certified.

DON'T

- ✗ *"An absolute perfect fit for your program, without a doubt!"*
- ✗ Claim a specific GPA or "NCAA-eligible" before it is verified.
- ✗ Use emojis in cold emails; they trip spam filters and read as junior.
- ✗ Fake personal detail ("he dreams of living in your town"). Coaches see it.

RECOMMENDED

IMAGERY & APPLICATIONS

Athlete media is the product. It should look consistent whether it is a thumbnail, a profile card or an email.

PHOTOGRAPHY

- **Prefer tight, sharp shots** of the athlete: upper body or a clean full-figure action frame.
- **Subject in focus,** background simple. Avoid wide, cluttered amateur-pitch scenes where the player is small.

- **Cut-outs** of the athlete over an aubergine field read as premium and on-brand.
- **Keep kit colors natural;** frame and graphics carry the Academo palette, not filters on the player.

GRAPHIC TREATMENT

- **Aubergine canvas, cream type,** monogram or lockup in a corner.
- **One accent moment** per asset (a ribbon, a stat), never a rainbow of colors.
- **Barlow Semi Condensed** for the athlete name, set large and uppercase.
- **Consistent data chips:** position, nationality, height, club, class year.

EMAIL SIGNATURE

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Name in Barlow Semi Condensed, role and contact in Barlow. Plain text, no image, so it never breaks in a coach's inbox or triggers spam filtering.